the difference between what is real and what is fantasy. With increased ability to ask questions in words, they understand people, objects and situation rapidly. After this, the child obeys commands but does not understand why things are right or wrong.

### f. Language Development

Early childhood is known as "the chatter box age" because children are able to speak with ease. They may use gestures but mainly as supplements to speech. During early childhood, there is a strong motivation to learn to speak. At approximately 2 years of age, their ability to use language suddenly increases rapidly. The formation of sentences follows a fairly definite and predictable pattern in early childhood. Two to three year old children usually use short sentences of three or four words. Many of the sentences are incomplete.

## 2.2.3.2 Late Childhood

Late childhood extends from the age of six years to the time the individual becomes sexually mature. This period is marked by conditions that profoundly affect a child's personal and social adjustment. The child enters school and experiences a major change in the life pattern.

**CASE STUDY**

Mary is 46 inches tall and weighs 18 kilograms at the end of six years. From these observations what is your inference about her weight and body type?

Answer: Mary is under weight and she has an ectomorphic body build due to being under weight

### Physical Development

Late childhood is a period of slow and uniform growth until the changes of puberty begins.

**Height and Weight-** The child's height and weight approximately reaches 2/3$^{rd}$ of adult height. Both boys and girls can be expected to grow about two to three inches each year. The average height for boys is slightly greater than that of girls throughout this period. However a girl's average height between ten and twelve years exceeds that of boys. At the onset of puberty, an average 11 years old girl has a height of 58 inches while an average boy of the same age has little lesser than that.

By 6 years of age, most children are about seven times their birth weight. Weight increase is at the rate of 1.3 to 2.3 kg. The average 11 year old girl weighs 40.1 kg and an average boy of the same age weighs 38.7 kg.

**Body proportions-** Body shapes of individuals are characterized by a greater proportion of body fat to muscle among females, while the opposite is true for males. Facial disproportions disappear as the mouth and jaw become larger, the forehead broadens and becomes slimmer, the neck becomes longer, the chest broadens, the abdomen flattens, the arms and legs lengthen and hands and feet grow larger but at a slow rate.

**Muscle development-** The increasing level and desire for physical activity in middle childhood reflects the increasing size and strength of a child's muscle. Gain in weight is due to increase in size of skeletal,



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